

September

12

1992 Black astronaut

Mae Jemison became the first Black American woman to travel to space when she was selected to be part of NASA's seven-person crew for the Space Shuttle *Endeavour*.



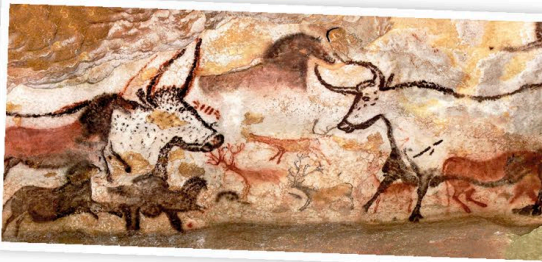
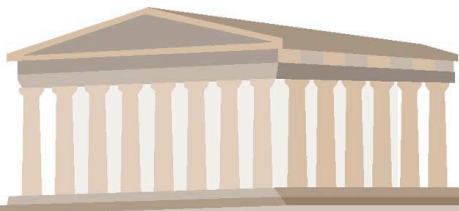
Born this day

1931 Ian Holm, British actor. Starting out in theatre, he went on to star in many films, including *The Lord of the Rings*.

1957 Hans Zimmer, German film score producer. One of the best-known composers in film, he has written music for more than 150 movies, including *The Lion King*.

490 BCE First marathon

After the first Persian invasion of Greece, the invaders were defeated at the Battle of Marathon. The best runner in the Greek camp, Pheidippides, ran 41 km (26 miles) from Marathon to Athens non-stop to deliver news of the victory. This run gave the modern-day marathon its name.



1940 Accidental discovery

While looking for hidden treasure in Montignac, France, a group of teenagers found a series of caves – now known as Lascaux – with ancient paintings on their walls. These paintings are nearly 17,000 years old.

Also on this day

1942 A German submarine sank the British ship RMS *Laconia* during World War II, killing more than 1,400 people.

2010 Tony Gonzalez became the first player in the USA's National Football League (NFL) to catch 1,000 passes in the "tight end" position.

2017 A 250 m (820 ft) long mass of solidified oil, grease, and plastics, nicknamed a "fatberg", was found blocking an underground sewer in London, UK.